

1). Explanation of Conventional Automobile Systems:

A conventional automobile is a vehicle powered mainly by an Internal Combustion (IC) Engine, where fuel such as petrol or diesel is burned inside the engine to produce mechanical power.

This power is transmitted through various systems to move the vehicle safely and efficiently.

1. Engine System:

The engine is the heart of the vehicle.

It converts the chemical energy of fuel into mechanical energy.

Main parts include:

Cylinder, Piston, Crankshaft, Connecting rod

Valves, Camshaft, Spark plug (petrol engine)

Fuel injector (diesel/modern petrol)

Function: Produces power to drive the vehicle.

3. Air Intake System

The engine requires air for combustion.

Components:

Air filter, Throttle body, Intake manifold

Mass Air Flow (MAF) sensor (modern vehicles)

Function: Supplies clean air to the engine.

5. Cooling System

Keeps the engine at its optimum operating temperature.

Components:

Radiator, Water pump, Thermostat, Cooling fan,

Coolant

Function: Prevents engine overheating.

7. Transmission System

Transfers engine power to the wheels.

Components:

Clutch (manual transmission), Gearbox, Propeller shaft (RWD), Differential, Axles

Function: Changes speed and torque according to driving conditions.

9. Suspension System

Absorbs road shocks and improves ride comfort.

Components:

Springs, Shock absorbers, Control arms, Stabilizer bar

Function: Provides stability and comfort.

11. Electrical System

Provides electrical power to vehicle components.

Components:

Battery, Alternator, Starter motor, Fuse box, Wiring harness, ECU

Function: Starts the engine and powers lights, sensors, and accessories.

2. Fuel System

The fuel system stores and supplies fuel to the engine in the correct quantity.

Components:

Fuel tank, Fuel pump, Fuel filter, Fuel lines,

Fuel injector/Carburettor, Pressure regulator

Function: Delivers clean fuel for efficient combustion.

4. Ignition System (Petrol Engine)

Creates the spark needed to ignite the air-fuel mixture.

Components:

Battery, Ignition switch, Ignition coil, Spark plugs, ECU (Electronic Control Unit)

Function: Starts combustion inside the cylinder.

6. Lubrication System

Reduces friction between moving engine parts.

Components:

Oil sump, Oil pump, Oil filter, Engine oil

Function: Minimizes wear, cools components, and extends engine life.

8. Steering System

Allows the driver to control the vehicle's direction.

Types:

Manual steering, Hydraulic Power Steering (HPS), Electric Power Steering (EPS)

Function: Changes the direction of travel.

10. Braking System

Slows down or stops the vehicle safely.

Types: Drum brake, Disc brake, ABS (Anti-lock Braking System)

Components:

Brake pedal, Master cylinder, Brake lines, Brake calliper, Brake pads/shoes

Function: Controls vehicle speed and ensures safety

12. Exhaust System

Removes burnt gases from the engine while reducing emissions and noise.

Components:

Exhaust manifold, Catalytic converter, Muffler (Silencer), Tailpipe

Function: Directs exhaust gases safely and reduces pollution.

Working Principle (Power Flow)

Fuel Tank → Fuel System → Engine → Clutch → Gearbox → Propeller Shaft → Differential → Axle → Wheels → Vehicle Movement

Summary: A conventional automobile consists of interconnected systems—engine, fuel, air intake, ignition, cooling, lubrication, transmission, steering, suspension, braking, electrical, and exhaust. Together, these systems convert fuel into mechanical power, transmit it to the wheels, ensure safe operation, and provide comfort and reliability.

2). Electric Vehicle (EV) Components and Their Working Principles

An **Electric Vehicle (EV)** is a vehicle powered by electricity stored in a **battery pack**. Unlike conventional vehicles, EVs do not use an internal combustion engine (ICE). Instead, an electric motor converts electrical energy into mechanical energy to drive the wheels.

Main Components of an Electric Vehicle

1. Battery Pack: The battery pack is the **main energy source** of an EV.

It stores electrical energy in rechargeable lithium-ion cells.

Components: Battery cells, Modules, Battery pack
Battery Management System (BMS)

Working Principle: Chemical energy is converted into electrical energy.

The battery supplies DC power to the inverter and other vehicle systems.

Function: Stores and supplies electrical energy.

3. Electric Motor

The electric motor converts electrical energy into mechanical energy.

Types: BLDC (Brushless DC Motor), PMSM (Permanent Magnet Synchronous Motor), AC Induction Motor

Working Principle:

Electrical current creates a rotating magnetic field. The magnetic interaction rotates the rotor.

Rotation drives the wheels.

Function: Provides propulsion.

5. DC-DC Converter

Converts high-voltage battery power into low voltage.

Working Principle:

Steps down battery voltage (e.g., 300–800 V to 12 V).

Function: Powers lights, infotainment, ECU, and charges the 12 V battery.

7. Charging Port

Provides the connection between the vehicle and the charging station.

Types:

AC charging and DC fast charging

Function: Transfers electrical energy into the battery.

9. Regenerative Braking System

Recovers energy during braking.

Working Principle:

During deceleration, the motor acts as a generator.

Kinetic energy is converted into electrical energy.

Recovered energy is stored back in the battery.

Function: Improves efficiency and extends driving range.

11. Vehicle Control Unit (VCU)

The VCU acts as the vehicle's central controller.

Functions:

Controls power distribution.

Coordinates communication between the battery, motor, inverter, and braking systems.

Manages driving modes and safety features.

Working Principle of an Electric Vehicle

Energy Flow:

Charging Station → **Charging Port** → **On-Board Charger (AC Charging)** → **Battery Pack** → **Inverter** → **Electric Motor** →

Reduction Gear → **Wheels** → **Vehicle Movement**

During Braking:

2. Battery Management System (BMS)

The BMS monitors and protects the battery.

Functions:

Monitors voltage, current, and temperature.

Balances cell voltages.

Prevents overcharging and deep discharge.

Ensures safe battery operation.

4. Inverter (Motor Controller)

The inverter controls motor operation.

Working Principle:

Converts DC power from the battery into AC power (for AC motors).

Controls motor speed and torque by varying voltage and frequency.

Function: Regulates motor performance.

6. On-Board Charger (OBC)

Charges the battery from an external AC supply.

Working Principle:

Converts AC electricity from the charging station into DC electricity for the battery.

Function: Enables AC charging.

8. Transmission (Reduction Gear)

Most EVs use a single-speed reduction gearbox.

Working Principle:

Reduces motor speed.

Increases torque before power reaches the wheels.

Function: Efficiently transfers motor power.

10. Thermal Management System

Maintains proper operating temperatures.

Components:

Coolant pump, Radiator, Cooling plates, Fans

Function:

Prevents overheating of the battery, motor, and power electronics.

Improves efficiency and battery life

12. Power Distribution Unit (PDU)

Safely distributes electrical power throughout the vehicle.

Function:

Supplies power to the inverter, charger, DC-DC converter, and auxiliary systems.

Includes fuses and relays for protection.

Wheels → Electric Motor (Generator Mode) → Inverter → Battery (Regenerative Charging)

Summary: An EV uses a **battery pack** to store electrical energy, a **BMS** to monitor battery health, an **inverter** to control electrical power, and an **electric motor** to drive the wheels. Supporting systems such as the **DC-DC converter**, **on-board charger**, **thermal management system**, **VCU**, and **regenerative braking system** work together to ensure safe, efficient, and reliable operation while maximizing energy efficiency and driving range.

3). Comparison Between Internal Combustion Engine (ICE) Vehicles and Electric Vehicles (EVs)

Parameter	ICE Vehicle	Electric Vehicle (EV)
Energy Source	Petrol, Diesel, CNG	Rechargeable Battery
Prime Mover	Internal Combustion Engine	Electric Motor
Working Principle	Fuel combustion produces mechanical power	Battery supplies electricity to motor
Efficiency	25–40%	85–95% (motor efficiency)
Tailpipe Emissions	CO ₂ , NO _x , HC, CO	Zero tailpipe emissions
Noise Level	High	Very Low
Maintenance	High (engine oil, filters, clutch, etc.)	Low (fewer moving parts)
Fuelling/Charging Time	3–5 minutes	30 minutes to several hours (depending on charger)
Running Cost	Higher	Lower
Initial Cost	Lower	Higher
Driving Range	Generally Higher	Depends on battery capacity
Transmission	Multi-speed gearbox	Mostly single-speed reduction gear
Torque Delivery	Gradual	Instant torque
Vibration	More	Minimal
Regenerative Braking	Not available	Available
Environmental Impact	Higher emissions	Lower operational emissions

4) Overview of the Advantages and Challenges of Electric Vehicles (EVs)

Advantages of Electric Vehicles (EVs)

1. Environment Friendly

Zero tailpipe emissions.
Reduces air pollution and greenhouse gas emissions.
Helps combat climate change.

3. Lower Running Cost

Electricity is generally cheaper than petrol or diesel.
Lower cost per kilometre.

5. Instant Torque and Better Performance

Electric motors deliver maximum torque from zero speed.
Smooth acceleration and improved driving experience.

7. Regenerative Braking

Recovers energy during braking.
Improves vehicle efficiency and extends driving range.

9. Government Incentives

Many governments provide subsidies, tax benefits, and incentives to encourage EV adoption.

2. High Energy Efficiency

Electric motors convert **85–95%** of electrical energy into mechanical energy.
Much more efficient than Internal Combustion Engine (ICE) vehicles.

4. Low Maintenance

Fewer moving parts compared to ICE vehicles.
No engine oil, spark plugs, fuel filters, or exhaust system maintenance.
Reduced servicing costs.

6. Quiet Operation

Produces very little noise and vibration.
Improves driving comfort and reduces noise pollution.

8. Energy Independence

Can be powered using renewable energy sources such as solar and wind.
Reduces dependence on fossil fuels.

Challenges of Electric Vehicles (EVs)

1. High Initial Cost: EVs generally cost more to purchase than comparable ICE vehicles due to battery costs.

2. Limited Driving Range

Driving range depends on battery capacity and driving conditions.
Long-distance travel may require charging stops.

3. Charging Time

Charging takes longer than refuelling a conventional vehicle.
Fast charging reduces time but is not available everywhere.

4. Charging Infrastructure

Public charging stations may be limited, especially in rural or remote areas.

5. Battery Degradation

Battery performance gradually decreases over time and with repeated charging cycles.

6. Battery Replacement Cost

Replacing a traction battery can be expensive, although warranties often cover many years of use.

7. Temperature Effects

Very hot or cold weather can reduce battery efficiency and available driving range.

8. Limited Availability of Raw Materials

Batteries require materials such as lithium, nickel, cobalt, and graphite.

Sustainable sourcing and recycling remain important challenges.

9. Grid Load

Large-scale EV adoption increases electricity demand, requiring upgrades to power generation and distribution systems.

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